integration with other outfits—accelerated in their aftermath. The conflation of the Indian locus with the jihad against America and its allies, which was among the defining features of Mumbai, also continued. Finally, as was the case at the time of those attacks, Lashkar members who still found their leaders too conservative or India-centric had other options to choose from.

Amalgamated Jihad

In March 2009 Lashkar launched its first major offensive inside Indian-administered Kashmir since the Mumbai attacks. Claiming credit for the ensuing firefight with Indian forces that killed twenty-five soldiers, Lashkar spokesman Abdullah Ghaznavi (believed to be an alias) warned, 'The gun battles should serve as a message to India that the struggle for Kashmir's freedom is on with full vigor.'[44] In reality the insurgency remained torpid. When Lashkar fidayeen attacked a police post in Srinagar in January 2010 before besieging a five star hotel, the attack was notable primarily because these assaults had become such a rarity.[45] Indeed civilian fatalities and terrorist incidents continued to decline.[46] According to one count, 375 people were killed in 2009, the last year for which such data was available at the time of writing. That is still more than one per day, but must be viewed within the context of a conflict that since 1989 has cost the lives of somewhere between 40–50,000 people (by the Indian army's count) and approximately 100,000 (according to the separatists).[47]

Although the number of infiltration attempts across the LoC increased over the previous year in 2009 for the first time since 2005, they also remained far lower than during the peak years of the insurgency.[48] According to Indian security officials, attempts remained at roughly the same level through mid-2010, but met with even less success. However, they also insisted that, despite these low numbers, the Pakistan army was continuing to allow this militant infiltration.[49] Most of those attempting to cross the LoC belonged to either Lashkar or Hizb-ul-Mujahideen, with the latter acting primarily in a support capacity for the former.[50]

Despite the fact that the Kashmir insurgency was moribund, India continued to maintain a heavy security presence. As a 2010 report by the International Crisis Group observed, the population was still 'subject to